

[Sign in](#)

PHARMA • OTC DRUGS

REACHING FOR THE COUNTERS

DESPITE HEALTH CONCERNS, THE INCREASING POPULARITY OF OTC DRUGS HAS LED TO PHARMA MAJORS SEIZING THE CHANCE TO DIVERSIFY THEIR REVENUE STREAMS. THE RISING **POPULARITY OF SKINCARE AND PERSONAL HEALTH HAS LED TO EASY ACCESS OF SEVERAL DERMATOLOGICAL PRODUCTS.** FROM D2C BRANDS TO ESTABLISHED PLAYERS, PHARMA COMPANIES ARE LOOKING TO BITE INTO THE PIE

BY NEETU CHANDRA SHARMA

G

GROWING AWARENESS ABOUT healthier lifestyles and increasing instances of lifestyle-related diseases have opened up the world of over-the-counter (OTC) drugs for both patients and pharmaceutical companies.

From headaches to a bout of acidity, patients turn to easily available OTC medications to alleviate common ailments. Add to that, the access to information through various social media platforms. According to the January 2023 edition of *The Cureus Journal*, an online medical journal, 60% of Indians

engage in self-medication. Medications like analgesics (66.25%) and antipyretics (59.16%) are commonly used for ailments like fever and body aches.

Typically, OTC drugs are those that are allowed to be sold without a doctor's prescription. Countries like the UK, the US, and Australia have clear guidelines for the sale of OTC drugs, but India lacks such regulations. In 2022, India approved a new OTC drug policy, but it was not implemented. The Indian government, in a bid to reduce treatment cost